



Case Study — Interview Candidates

Project GlobalLogistics

GenAI Strategic Transformation · Engagement Manager case

Prepared by WAIMAKERS | **For** interview candidates | **Time guide** 1.5–2 hrs preparation

This case is fictional. Any resemblance to real organisations or individuals is coincidental.

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How to prepare

At WAIMAKERS we believe in using GenAI to augment human intelligence — so we **explicitly encourage you to use ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or any tool you like** to work this case. We are not testing whether you can memorise frameworks. We want to see your ability to:

- Structure a complex, ambiguous transformation with a clear strategic approach;
- Apply GenAI *realistically* to solve real business problems — including its limits;
- Work with messy, real-world inputs the way a consultant actually receives them;
- Design a roadmap that balances technology with human capability-building.

Format is up to you

Share your thinking in whatever format works best — a written document, slides, a walkthrough, a working prototype prompt/GPT, or a combination. We care about your reasoning and how you handle the inputs, not the polish of the deliverable.

1. Client context

GlobalLogistics B.V. is a leading European customs & trade-compliance provider with **350 employees** across the Netherlands, Germany and Belgium. They clear goods across borders for large importers and exporters who rely on them to keep shipments moving without delay.

Annual volume	Workforce	Revenue model
500k+ customs declarations / year	350 FTEs (mostly declarants)	Hourly transactional billing

Exhibit 1 — Operational reality (today, largely manual)

Process step	Current state (manual)	Pain point
1. Intake	Client emails with PDF / Excel attachments	Unstructured data, very high volume, every client different
2. Data entry	Manual typing into legacy software	~45 min / declaration, error-prone
3. Classification	Manual lookup of HS commodity codes	Requires scarce senior expertise
4. Submission	Submit to Customs	Fines & penalties if data is incorrect

2. The strategic challenge

Market pressure

- **Talent crisis** — experienced declarants are retiring; younger talent finds manual data entry unappealing.
- **Commoditisation** — competitors are using automation to drop the price per declaration.
- **Scalability trap** — GlobalLogistics sells hours. To grow revenue they must hire more people — which erodes margin.

★ The CEO's "North Star" vision

"We must move from manual creation to AI-automated creation with human validation. Our people will be advisors, not typists."

CURRENT STATE

80% data entry / 20% advisory

TARGET STATE

20% validation / 80% advisory

Exhibit 2 — Key stakeholders (you will have met them in the discovery interviews)

Alex Reijnders

CEO — THE SPONSOR

Ambitious but skeptical of hype.
Worries about compliance risk.
Wants to see ROI.

Bart Coppens

CFO — THE REALIST

Owns the P&L. Margin per
declaration is falling; needs a
hard business case and payback.

Jordan Smit

COO — THE CHAMPION

Tech-savvy. Frustrated by
manual errors. Wants
standardisation across all three
countries.

Morgan de Laet

CHRO — THE PROTECTOR

Protective of culture. Fears AI will mean job losses.
Focused on people & wellbeing.

Henk Mulder

SENIOR DECLARANT — THE VETERAN

38 years' experience, retires in ~14 months. The HS-
classification knowledge lives in his head.

3. Your data room

To work this case you have been given a realistic — and deliberately **messy** — set of materials, exactly as a consultant would receive them at the start of an engagement. **Part of what we are assessing is how you make sense of this raw input.** You will not have time to read all of it manually; show us how you would approach it.

In the package	What it is & how to treat it
5 discovery interviews (Interviews/ — markdown)	Transcripts with the CEO, CFO, COO, CHRO and a senior declarant. They corroborate — and occasionally contradict — each other. Extract the real story.
3 system exports (Systems_Data/ — Excel)	Raw, ugly exports from their systems: ~11,000 declaration records across multiple sheets, an HR/workforce file, and a billing workbook. Inconsistent headers, missing codes, totals that don't reconcile. Real client data.
~500 client documents (Client_Data_Dump/ — PDF, scans, Excel)	A genuine intake "data dump": commercial invoices, packing lists, transport documents, intake emails and certificates — many languages, inconsistent formats, near-duplicates, and a large share of scanned documents with no text layer . This is the volume problem from Exhibit 1, made real.

We are interested in **how** you would ingest, structure and exploit this material with GenAI (e.g. extraction, OCR/vision, classification, reconciliation, summarisation) — not in you processing all 500 documents by hand. A small working proof-of-concept on a sample is very welcome.

4. Your assignment

You have been brought in as the **Engagement Manager** to lead this transformation. Walk us through how you would approach the project. Consider addressing:

- 1 Project approach & scoping**
 - How would you structure the engagement? What phases?
 - What would you need to gather in the first few weeks?
 - How would you prioritise which problems to tackle first, and why?
- 2 Stakeholder management**
 - Beyond the five above, who else is critical to engage (e.g. works council, Customs authority)?
 - How do you navigate the tension between cost pressure and employee concerns?
 - What is your strategy for building buy-in across three countries?
- 3 Solution design**
 - Which GenAI use cases would you explore across the four process steps, and how would you evaluate them?
 - How do you balance quick wins versus longer-term transformation?
 - What risks (e.g. compliance, hallucinated HS codes) concern you most, and how would you mitigate them?
- 4 Change management & adoption**
 - How would you approach the people side — reskilling 350 staff of varying digital literacy?
 - How do you make “advisor, not typist” real rather than a euphemism for cuts?
 - How would you measure success beyond technical implementation?
- 5 Execution & governance**
 - How would you sequence the work to maximise value and minimise risk?
 - What governance structure would you recommend?
 - How do you ensure the transformation is sustainable after the engagement ends?

Note: there are no “right answers” here. We want to understand how you think, how you structure ambiguity, how you handle messy real-world data, and how you balance competing priorities.